

Stock engine setup

No engine changes. This is the easiest way to get Vision GTAO running.

1

Copy the plugin

Put the repository in YourProject/Plugins/VisionGTAO.

2

Build and enable it

Build the project, then enable Vision GTAO in the Plugins window.

3

Place the actor

Add one Vision GTAO actor to the level.

4

Use Stock Engine

Leave Integration Mode on Stock Engine (Post Opaque).

5

Turn off the old PPV

Do not run the old GTAO blendable at the same time.

Heavy fog needs a shorter range

The stock hook happens late enough that GTAO can look like it is layered over the fog. Lower Fade Out Distance so the AO stays near the camera and fades before the fog gets heavy.

Good starting point

Radius: 40-80 cm Quality: High Denoise: On

Use a smooth Fade Out Radius so the cutoff does not show on walls.

Engine hook setup

Use this when GTAO needs to happen before fog, water, and translucency.

1. Add the view extension function

SceneViewExtension.h

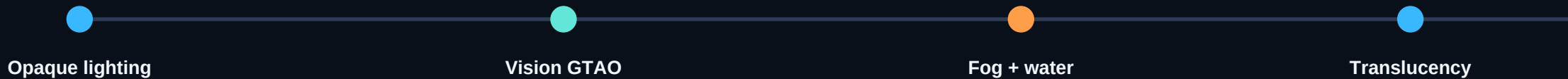
Add PostRenderOpaqueLighting_RenderThread directly after PostRenderBasePassDeferred_RenderThread.

```
virtual void PostRenderOpaqueLighting_RenderThread(... ) {}
```

2. Call it after opaque lighting

DeferredShadingRenderer.cpp

Inside FDeferredShadingSceneRenderer::Render, call it after deferred opaque lighting and before Early translucency velocity pass.

**3**

Rebuild

Rebuild the source engine and project.

4

Enable Engine Hook

Set Integration Mode to Engine Hook or use `r.VisionGTAO.UseEngineHook 1`.

Controls that matter

Start simple. These are the settings you will adjust most often.

Radius

How far the AO search reaches.

Contrast

Deepens or softens the result.

Fade Out Distance

Where GTAO is completely gone.

Thin Occluder Compensation

Helps with masked screens and detached depth.

Intensity

Makes the AO stronger without changing radius.

Minimum Visibility

Stops the darkest AO from reaching full black.

Fade Out Radius

How smoothly the distance fade happens.

Luminance Influence

Lightens AO in areas that are already dark.

High quality is usually enough. Keep denoise on with TSR, TAA, or DLSS.